

July

3

1987

Across the ocean

British billionaire Richard Branson and Swedish pilot Per Lindstrand set a world record when they became the first people to cross the Atlantic Ocean in a hot-air balloon. They landed in Limavady, Northern Ireland, having flown 4,947 km (3,074 miles) from Maine, USA.



Born this day

1962 Tom Cruise, US actor. One of the most successful film stars of all time, he has played the lead role in more than 40 films, including blockbuster action movies such as *Top Gun* and the *Mission Impossible* series.

Fastest steam engine

The British steam engine *Mallard* reached a speed of 203 kph (126 mph) near Grantham, UK, setting a world speed record for steam locomotives that remains unbroken.

1938



Also on this day

1863 The Northern Army achieved its first major victory over Southern forces at the Battle of Gettysburg, turning the tide in the US Civil War.

1886 Engineer Karl Benz drove his three-wheeled Motorwagen – the world's first automobile – through the streets of Mannheim in Germany.

1928 Shades of red, blue, and green came alive on screen when Scottish inventor John Logie Baird demonstrated the first colour TV.

Magic trick

2004

Led by US magician Monty Witt, 129 magicians formed the world's longest linking ring chain. They joined together 534 steel rings at a convention of the International Brotherhood of Magicians in Cleveland, USA.

